

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Later Vedic source, chronology and eastward shift

RIGVEDIC LAYERS -> SAMAVEDA/YAJURVEDA/ATHARVAVEDA -> BRAHMANAS -> UPANISHADS

earlier NW world ritual corpora explanation reflection/critique

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broad c. 1000-600 BCE: Punjab/upper Ganga-Yamuna -> Kuru-Panchala -> Kosala-Videha

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Textual sequence is relative and layered; it is not an annual political chronicle.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Forest-agriculture-iron-surplus mechanism

forest edge + alluvial soils + rainfall + growing labour organisation

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iron in expanding use + heavier ploughing + cattle traction + crop diversification

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stable fields/surplus -> larger settlements -> crafts -> political extraction

CAUTION: iron helped within an ecological-social package; it did not create states alone.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Jana to janapada: territorial political change

KIN GROUP/JANA -> STABLE SETTLEMENT -> TERRITORIAL JANAPADA -> STRONGER KINGSHIP

lineage loyalty fields/claims bounded peoples share, force, ritual

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Assemblies persist but lose relative weight; monarchy grows without instant bureaucracy. This bridges to Mahajanapadas, but no inevitable one-way state ladder.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Later Vedic political institution system

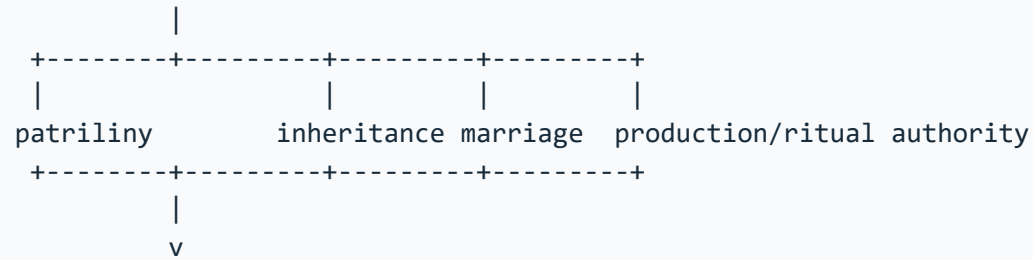
RAJAN

- |-- ratnins: politically and ritually significant figures
- |-- purohita: legitimation | senani: force | gramani: local linkage
- |-- sabha/samiti: continued assemblies with changing influence
- |-- bali and ruler share: less regular than later taxation
- +> royal rituals advertise supremacy and mobilise elite consensus

Authority grows through territory, surplus, ritual and force together.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Household, gender, varna and social ordering

GRIHAPATI-CENTRED HOUSEHOLD



varna firms: Brahmana authority + Kshatriya power + producers + servants

Gender constraints grow in many texts; female seers/debaters prevent a uniform claim.

Gotra expands; later jati and full four-ashrama scheme require caution.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Sacrifice as political economy

SURPLUS + SPECIALISED PRIESTS + ROYAL AMBITION

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RAJASUYA: consecration | ASHVAMEDHA: sovereignty | VAJAPEYA: power/prestige

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redistributes gifts/animals

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ranks ruler, priests and participants

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Ritual stages, legitimises and negotiates power; it does not merely reflect it.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Upanishadic turn: ritual transformed inward

PROBLEM: sacrifice promises results but leaves death, self and ultimate reality open.

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karma/rebirth + brahman-atman inquiry + knowledge as liberating discipline

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internalisation of sacrifice

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critique/reinterpretation of ritual monopoly

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Not total rejection: Upanishadic thought grows within and transforms Vedic tradition.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Early versus Later Vedic comparison

AXIS	EARLY VEDIC	LATER VEDIC
space	Sapta-Sindhu/NW	upper Ganga-Yamuna/eastward
polity	jana, rajan, assemblies	janapada, kingship, ratnins
economy	cattle-centred mixed base	plough farming, surplus, crafts
society	flexible differentiation	firmer varna, patriarchy, gotra
religion	deity praise/yajna	royal rites + Upanishadic inquiry
material	mixed correlates	PGW useful; not an ethnic identity

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Later Vedic answer architecture

10 MARKS: identify change -> mechanism -> Vedic term/ritual -> continuity caveat

15 MARKS: source/space -> economy -> polity -> society -> religion -> PGW caution

20 MARKS: eastward ecology -> iron/agriculture -> jana-janapada -> institutions

-> household/varna/gender -> sacrifice -> Upanishadic turn -> state bridge

Avoid iron-caused-kingdoms and women-lost-all-status claims; grade evidence.

CLOSE: territoriality, surplus and ritual hierarchy deepened cumulatively.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Evidence ladder and confidence control

EVIDENCE LADDER

1. = from source book = inference / standard knowledge = current affairs.
2. # Claim Named evidence Significance Limitation
3. Year Paper Q PYQ demand (neutral rendering) Directive / format Source...

VERDICT: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Examiner traps and contested boundaries

CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

1. Contested issues Competing interpretations are attributed, evidenced...
2. Inscription and coin evidence: contemporary names, titles, claims and...
3. Horizon Safe working range What it means What it must not be...

VERDICT: Qualification earns marks; false certainty is a hard failure.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Integrated answer spine and qualified conclusion

ANSWER SPINE

1. Evidence key: FACT = directly supported by named repository/local-...
2. Original solved 10-mark Mains 3
3. Original solved 15-mark Mains 3

VERDICT: Claim, named evidence, analysis and qualification lead to a graded...